CONSULT FOR AFRICA

The CFA MBA

A management education built on our own work

Prepared for Ezinne Orji and Abigail Oladejo, the first cohort
Consult for Africa internal. Not for circulation outside the firm.
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A note from Debo

Ezinne, Abigail,

You run my office and you coordinate care for Mezo's patients. Every day you work with hospital owners, doctors, patients and boards. I want you to understand this business as well as anyone who manages in it, so I am putting you through an MBA built on our own work.

It runs for a year. It covers what a business school covers: finance, operations, marketing, strategy, people, negotiation and governance. But it is taught on Nigerian healthcare, and the cases are our own engagements. It starts with medicine itself, and with managing work through other people.

It is built to run without me. Each course has a reviewer from the firm, your work comes through the task board, and I will read your capstones.

Debo

Summary

- Aim: by October 2027 you can manage in healthcare: read a hospital's numbers, run a team, deal with doctors, patients and boards, and judge a commercial decision.
- Length: 12 courses and a capstone, 9 November 2026 to 29 October 2027, in four terms.
- Time: about four hours a week. Most of it is done on live work, not beside it.
- Material: a workbook for each course, sent the week before it starts, with weekly tests and exercises. The cases are CFA engagements.
- Personal: each course has a core everyone takes and a track for each of you. Ezinne's track leans to management and the executive office. Abigail's leans to patient operations and Mezo.
- Faculty: a reviewer from the firm for each course marks your weekly work and examines you. Debo reads the capstones.
- The Academy: where an Academy foundation track covers a course's basics, it is set as pre-reading. Abigail's Friday Academy hour continues.

1. The curriculum

Term	Course	Dates	Reviewer
1. Foundations	C1 Medicine and the Hospital	9 Nov to 18 Dec, exam 7 Jan	Dr Adediwura Okeleye
	C2 Managing Through Others	9 Nov to 4 Dec	Dr Adediwura Okeleye
	C3 Writing and Communicating for Business	11 Jan to 29 Jan	Dr Adediwura Okeleye
2. The business of healthcare	C4 The Nigerian Health Market and Health Economics	1 Feb to 26 Feb	Dr Adediwura Okeleye
	C5 Accounting and Hospital Finance	1 Mar to 2 Apr	to be named
	C6 Data, Spreadsheets and Decisions	5 Apr to 30 Apr	to be named

Term	Course	Dates	Reviewer
3. Running and growing	C7 Operations: Patient Flow and Reading a Hospital	3 May to 4 Jun	Dr Adediwura Okeleye
	C8 Marketing and Patient Acquisition	7 Jun to 2 Jul	Toluwanimi Olayeni
	C9 Strategy and the Consulting Method	5 Jul to 30 Jul	Dr Adediwura Okeleye
4. Leading	C10 Leading People and Organisations	2 Aug to 27 Aug	Oludayo Olugbamigbe
	C11 Negotiation and Commercial Judgement	30 Aug to 24 Sep	to be named
	C12 Governance, Law and Ethics in Healthcare	27 Sep to 15 Oct	to be named
Capstone	A real piece of client or Mezo work, defended	18 Oct to 29 Oct	Debo

2. The courses

C1 Medicine and the Hospital

- Content: medical terminology, the body by system, hospital roles and documents, tests and procedures, how patients and money move.
- Mezo strand: in every week, matching a caller's words to the right specialist, red flags, preparing patients, HMO checks. Starts with the Care Coordinator Safety Card, which applies from today.
- Workbook: attached.

C2 Managing Through Others

- Content: writing a brief someone else can finish without asking, choosing who and how much to delegate, check-ins and review, feedback, running a small team's week.
- Ezinne's track: tasks you write for Favour, Ruth and Abigail, and breaking Debo's work into sub-tasks.
- Abigail's track: briefing Mezo facilities and doctors, and asking colleagues for what you need.
- Workbook: attached.

C3 Writing and Communicating for Business

- Content: the firm's house style, answer first, memos, minutes, client emails, WhatsApp to senior doctors, presenting to a room.
- Cases: rewriting real office documents to the standard.
- Pre-reading: Academy, Professional Standards.

C4 The Nigerian Health Market and Health Economics

- Content: who pays (out of pocket, HMOs, NHIA, state schemes, corporates, diaspora), who regulates, who owns, and why each behaves as it does.
- Cases: Aman HMO's network, Haven's board, Arabella in Abuja.
- Pre-reading: Academy, Healthcare Fundamentals.

C5 Accounting and Hospital Finance

- Content: the income statement, balance sheet and cash flow; revenue lines; costs; tariffs; payer mix; debtor days; why profitable hospitals run out of cash.
- Cases: reading a client's monthly figures, with commercial terms removed.
- Pre-reading: Academy, Financial Literacy for Healthcare.

C6 Data, Spreadsheets and Decisions

- Content: clean data, lookups, pivot tables, a chart that makes one point, and reading a number critically.
- Cases: the platform's own pipeline and Mezo request data.

C7 Operations: Patient Flow and Reading a Hospital

- Content: patient flow, waits and bottlenecks, capacity, theatre and bed use, quality and safety systems.
- Practicum: a structured walk through a client site or a Mezo network facility, written up as an observation note.

C8 Marketing and Patient Acquisition

- Content: how patients choose a doctor, referral networks, pricing, digital channels, the rules on advertising medical services.
- Cases: Mezo, the aesthetics businesses, the AGELESS evening.

C9 Strategy and the Consulting Method

- Content: structuring a problem, hypotheses, evidence, the pyramid principle, building a recommendation.
- Cases: the Haven growth strategy and the Medbury division.
- Pre-reading: Academy, Core Consulting Skills.

C10 Leading People and Organisations

- Content: hiring, onboarding, evaluation, culture, conflict, motivation, and managing professionals who are senior to you.
- Cases: Haven's culture work, the office itself.

C11 Negotiation and Commercial Judgement

- Content: preparing a negotiation, anchors and concessions, reading the other side, saying no, contracts in plain English.
- Cases: how the firm's own deals were shaped, without the figures.

C12 Governance, Law and Ethics in Healthcare

- Content: boards and committees, board packs and minutes, clinical governance, the Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023, medical ethics, conflicts of interest.
- Cases: Havana's two-family board, House of Refuge's readiness work.

Capstone

- Ezinne: a full briefing and decision pack on a hospital Debo is about to meet: the market, the numbers, the people and a recommendation.
- Abigail: the Mezo care coordination playbook: matching, safety, payers, follow-up, built from a year of doing it.
- Defence: 45 minutes with Debo and the course reviewers.

3. How a course runs

When	What	Time
Tuesday	Read the week's section; do the drill or practice	2 hours
During the week	The exercise, done on live work wherever possible	1 hour
Friday	The weekly test, closed book, answers on your task	30 minutes

- Tasks: one per course per week on your desk, assigned by the course reviewer, due Friday.
- In November two courses run together (C1 and C2). That is the heaviest month of the year. From January it is one course at a time.

4. Assessment and the award

Measure	Typical weight (each workbook sets its own)
Weekly tests	30%
Exercises on live work	30%
Course exam or practical	40%

- Course pass: 75%. A course not passed is retaken in the next gap between courses.
- Award: the CFA MBA certificate, issued by the firm when all twelve courses and the capstone are passed. It is an internal award, not a university degree, and the record behind it is what counts.
- Progression: results feed your monthly evaluation under Learning, and the capstone counts as evidence toward the firm's first consultant tier.

5. What we ask of you

- Protect the Tuesday block. Move it if you must; do not drop it.
- Use it at work the same week. A term used correctly in a minute, or a brief that worked first time, is worth more than a test score.
- Ask the reviewer when stuck, as a comment on the week's task.
- Learn together. Ezinne and Abigail drill and review each other's work every week.